Domestic Violence (DV) Shelters	Number	Page
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Revision Date:
06/01/2024

Background:
Individuals residing in Domestic Violence (DV) shelters are not considered to be residents of an institution and are considered separate households (HHs) and are eligible to apply for CalFresh.

Purpose:
This section provides policies regarding CalFresh applications for customers residing in DV shelters. This section is being revised after sunset review, there are no changes being made due to state legislation. The section title is updating the term “Battered Person Shelters” to “Domestic Violence (DV) Shelters”.

Policy:
DV shelters are defined as public or private nonprofit residential facilities that serve battered individuals. If the facility also serves other individuals, a portion of the facility must be set aside on a long-term basis to serve only victims of DV and/or individuals with children. Prior to certifying shelter residents, it must be determined that the shelter meets the definition of a DV shelter.

Customers temporarily residing in DV shelters may apply for CalFresh on their own behalf or through an Authorized Representative (AR). Customers residing in DV shelters that have already received benefits for the current month as a member of their abuser’s CalFresh HH may apply as a separate HH and may be eligible for an additional allotment of benefits in their own case. The customer must complete a new application. Benefits must be issued under a different case name, number, and new Electronic Benefit Transfer (EBT) card.

1. Income/Resources/Expenses

Customers residing in DV shelters will be certified using the income, resources, and expenses that they are responsible for at the time of application. Income, resources, or expenses of their former HH will not be considered available to the customer. Resources held jointly with members of their former HH will not be considered available to the customer.

2. Actions on Former Case

If the victim of DV is the head of HH, they may request to close the former CalFresh case that included the abuser. Requests to close a case by the head of HH are considered Verified Upon Receipt (VUR) and require no further verification.

If the request is made…	then discontinue the case with…
verbally,	timely and adequate notice.
in writing or in the presence of staff,	adequate notice, timely notice is not required.

If the abuser is head of HH, action must be taken to ensure the former HH’s eligibility and allotment reflects the change in the HH’s composition. The former CalFresh HH will be notified of the adverse action and change in HH composition with timely and adequate notice.

Note: Document all actions in the case record.

References:
All County Information Notice (ACIN) I-09-18.
All County Letters (ACLs) 17-30; 19-51; 21-101.
Manual of Policies and Procedures (MPP) 63-102; 63-503.

Sunset Date:
This policy will be reviewed for continuance on or by 06/30/2027.

Approval for Release:
6-27-24

Rick Wanne, Director
Self-Sufficiency Services